also difficult to operationalize as empirical testing is difficult. There is a gap between theory and research. It is, therefore, limited in scope.

Kaplan's models of international system has been subjected to rigorous criticisms. It is argued that the system not only offers limited possibilities but its merit is also limited. The first two models roughly correspond to real situations in the backdrop of particular historical trajectories. The other four models are totally hypothetical, impracticable and arbitrary. It was almost like an intellectual exercise on Kaplan's part without any reference to reality. Kaplan's model also neglected the role of geo-strategic factors as well as national and sub-national factors. However, the criticisms do not mean that the systems approach is absolutely without merit. It has made significant contribution in the scientific study of behaviour in international relations. It can be used along with other approaches to the study of international relations.